

such as a popup blocker, tabbed browsing and an integrated download manager. However, shortcut features such as writing the URL then pressing [Ctrl] + [Enter] to automatically fill in the “www.” and “.com” parts of the URL were not available in version 0.1.

Phoenix 0.2 was released a few days later on 10 October 2002 and had plenty of more features compared to the previous release. The major change in this version was the tool bar which had undergone a complete change. The side bar made its first appearance in this version. Other enhancements were implemented including new options to the preferences section. Now users were able to disable Java and edit some tabbed-browsing options. Phoenix 0.2 also introduced the ability to add extensions and themes to the browser.

Phoenix version 0.3 was the first release of Mozilla that had an integrated search engine by default in the toolbar. The Mozilla team at the time was concentrating on enhancing the browser and spent most of their time on doing that. Although this release had bug fixes, it was still buggy and unstable.

The next major change came with the release of the Firebird browser. Yes, Mozilla changed the name of the browser from Phoenix to Firebird. This was done to avoid trademark issues with a company called Phoenix Technologies, which makes a browser of its own. After months of brainstorming, the Mozilla team rested on a new name, Firebird. However, the name Firebird had to be changed again later because Firebird was the name of an open source development project that makes a relational database.

The general look and feel of the browser was also changed to support the name change. The term “Preferences” turned into “Options”, and the Options window obtained some eye candy. If Firebird 0.6 crashed, the user was now able to submit a message to the developers about this error. The downside to this new browser was the increase in the file size which was an increase by about 6MB.